VICTORY 2027

Treasure Chest : POETRY

The Glove and the Lions

Lecture 03 | ENGLISH

Nupur Ma'am

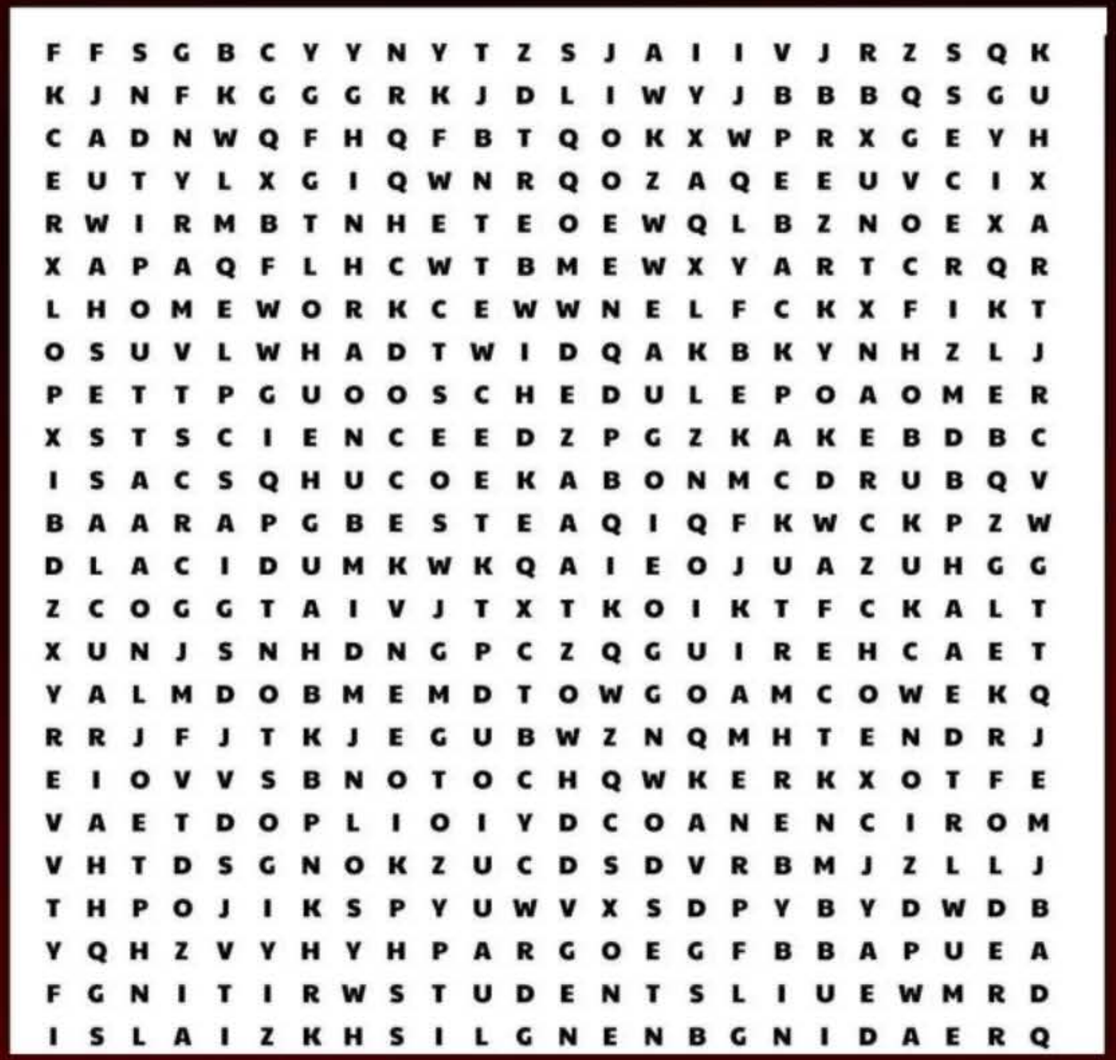


TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1. Overview
2. Line by Line Explanation
3. Vocabulary Building
4. Poetic Devices, Summary and Themes
5. MCQs for Practice



TOPIC: WORD SEARCH



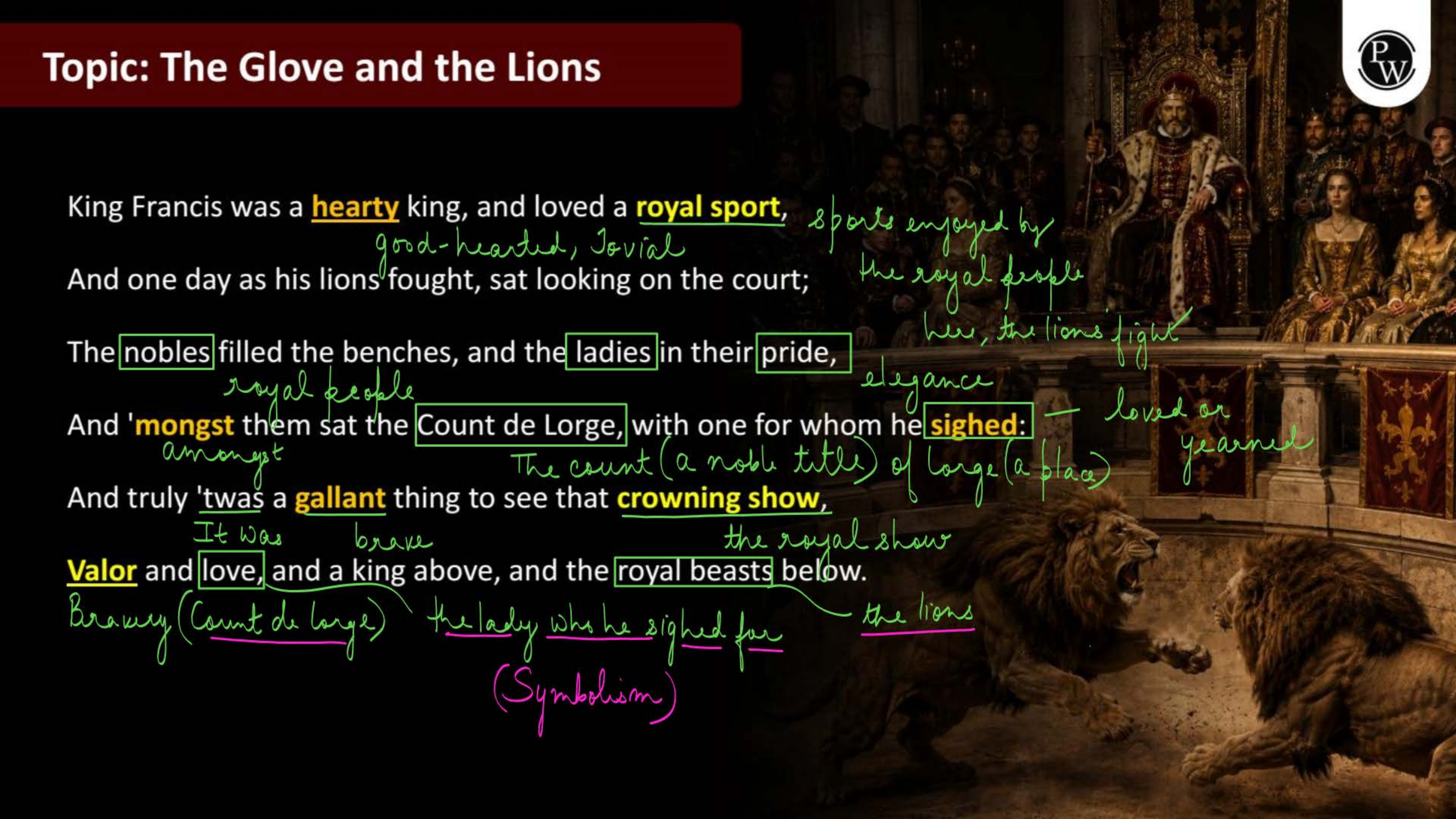
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Topic: Overview

‘The Glove and the Lions’ by **Leigh Hunt** describes the dangerous games of love played in the royal court of the king and the consequences of going too far.



Topic: The Glove and the Lions



King Francis was a **hearty** king, and loved a **royal sport**,
good-hearted, Jovial — sports enjoyed by the royal people
And one day as his lions fought, sat looking on the court;

The nobles filled the benches, and the ladies in their pride,
royal people — elegance
And 'mongst them sat the Count de Lorge, with one for whom he **sighed**:
amongst — The count (a noble title) of Lorge (a place) — loved or yearned
And truly 'twas a **gallant** thing to see that **crowning show**,
It was — brave — the royal show
Valor and love, and a king above, and the royal beasts below.
Bravery (Count de Lorge) — the lady who he sighed for — the lions

(Symbolism)

Topic: The Glove and the Lions



Ramped and roared the lions, with **horrid** laughing jaws;
They bit, they glared, gave blows like beams, a wind went with their paws;
With **wallowing** might and **stifled** roar they rolled on one another;
Till all the pit with sand and mane was in a **thunderous smother**;
The bloody foam above the bars came **whisking** through the air;

Said Francis then, "**Faith, gentlemen, we're better here than there.**

Topic: MCQ

How did the lions behave?

1. They were silent.
2. They ramped.
3. They were feeble.
4. They roared.

roared

Weak

A) 2 and 4

B) 2 and 3

C) 1 and 3

D) 1 and 4

Topic: MCQ

What was the pit covered with?

1. Bystanders
2. Lions
3. Sand
4. Mane → lions' hair

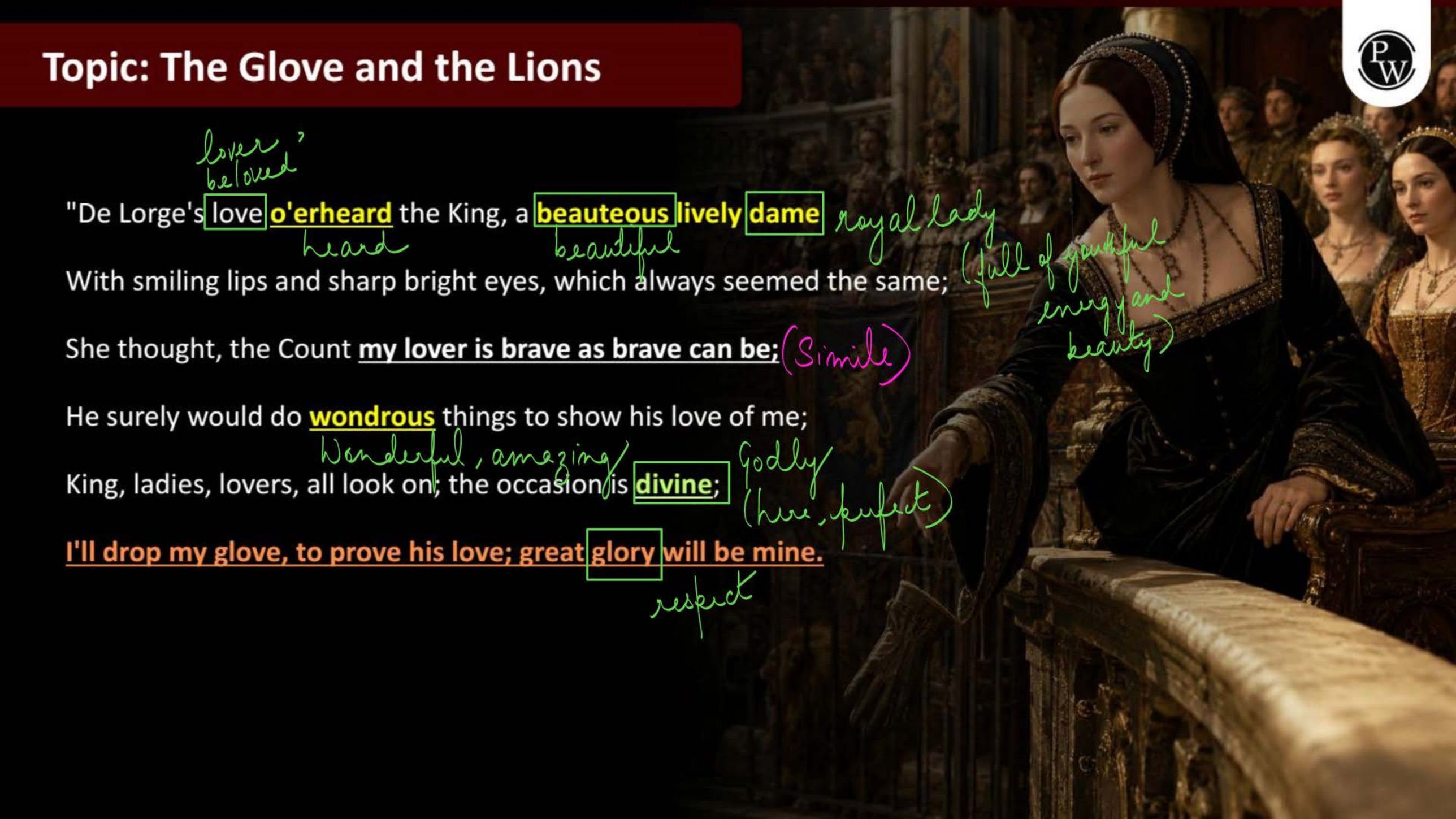
A) 1 and 4

B) 1 and 3

C) 2 and 3

D) 3 and 4

Topic: The Glove and the Lions



"De Lorge's love o'erheard the King, a beauteous lively dame

With smiling lips and sharp bright eyes, which always seemed the same;

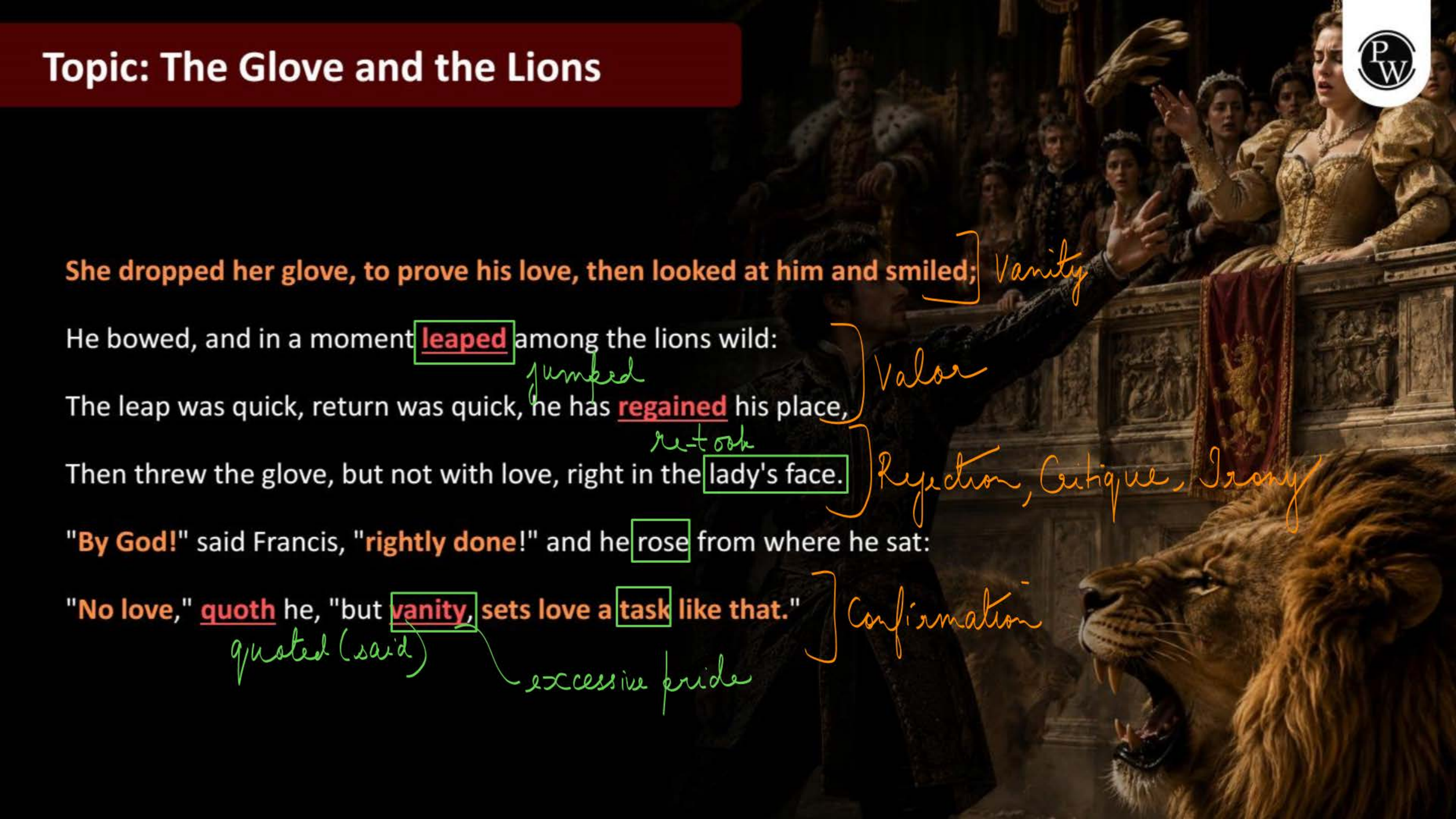
She thought, the Count **my lover is brave as brave can be;**

He surely would do **wondrous** things to show his love of me;

King, ladies, lovers, all look on; the occasion is **divine**;

I'll drop my glove, to prove his love; great glory will be mine.

Topic: The Glove and the Lions



She dropped her glove, to prove his love, then looked at him and smiled; Vanity

He bowed, and in a moment **leaped** among the lions wild:

jumped

The leap was quick, return was quick, he has **regained** his place, } Valor

re-took

Then threw the glove, but not with love, right in the lady's face. } Rejection, Critique, Irony

"**By God!**" said Francis, "**rightly done**!" and he rose from where he sat:

"**No love,**" **quoth** he, "but **vanity, sets love a task like that.**" } Confirmation

quoted (said)

excessive pride

Topic: MCQ

Who is King Francis described as?

A) A peaceful king

B) A hearty king

C) A cruel king

D) A quiet king

Topic: The Glove and the Lions

'The Glove and the Lions' is a poem about **a brave man who goes to extreme lengths to prove his love, but things do not go quite as expected.**

The poem starts in a king's court where everyone is watching a dangerous lion fight. Among the audience, **there's a man named Count de Lorge who really likes a woman in the crowd.**



Topic: The Glove and the Lions

This woman knows that the Count likes her, **so she thinks of a daring test for him to prove his love for her.**

This test involves her **dropping her glove into the pit where the lions are fighting and expecting him to jump in and get it back for her.**



Topic: Summary

To her glee, Count de Lorge does not back down from this challenge; upon the throwing of the glove, **he quickly jumps into the pit, grabs the glove, and hops back out before the lions can harm him.**

But instead of giving the glove back to the woman as a symbol of his love, **he throws it at her face.** The King, who's been watching all of this, thinks that what the Count did was right. **He believes the woman was just showing off and that it was not fair to test love in such a dangerous way.** The poem ends with the King saying that it was the woman's vanity, not true love, that made her drop the glove in the first place.



Topic: ~~Summary~~ Poetic Devices

Device	Instance
IMAGERY Image 5 senses	The poet uses vividly descriptive language to help the reader visualise the scene. For example, ***"Ramped and roared the lions, with horrid laughing jaws"*** uses imagery to help the reader see and hear the ferocious lions.
SIMILE → Comparision – 'like' and 'as'	A simile is a figure of speech that makes a direct comparison between two different things using *"like"* or *"as"*. In the line ***"They bit, they glared, gave blows like beams"*** the poet uses a simile to compare the lions' blows to beams, implying their strength and impact.
METAPHOR → Comparision → Without using 'as' and 'like'	The poet uses metaphor to compare unrelated things. The phrase ***"a wind went with their paws"*** is metaphorical, suggesting the speed and power of the lions' movements.

'w' → alliteration

Topic: ~~Summary~~ Poetic Devices

Device	Instance
PERSONIFICATION → non-human → human attributes	The poet uses personification to give human characteristics to non-human entities. For instance, ***"horrid laughing jaws"*** attributes a human action (laughing) to the lions' jaws.
⭐IRON⭐ Underlying meaning ≠ literal meaning	The poet uses irony when the actions or statements have an underlying meaning that contrasts with their literal meaning. In the end, ***the lady expects a display of love from the Count, but he throws the glove in her face, a distinctly unloving gesture.***
ALLITERATION	Alliteration is the repetition of the same sound at the beginning of words. An instance is ***"Ramped and roared"*** where the ***'r'*** sound is repeated.

Topic: ~~Summary~~ Poetic Devices

Device	Instance
RHYME	The poem uses a regular rhyme scheme, which is ***ABAB*** for most of the poem.
★ SYMBOLISM ★	Certain items in the poem are used symbolically. For instance, ***the glove symbolises the lady's test of love, and the lions symbolise danger and challenge.*** Count de Lorge = Valor Beauteous lively Dame → love Vanity
HYPERBOLA Exaggeration	The poet uses hyperbole, or exaggeration, to emphasise the danger of the lions. For example, ***describing their blows like beams is likely an exaggeration of their actual strength.***

Doubts

Poetic Devices

① Onomatopoeia → (sound words) → Roared

② Paradox → (opposite ideas) horrid laughing Jaws
(horrible) ≠ a happy activity

Oxymoron
opposite terms written together
→ bittersweet
→ considerable speck

Topic: Themes

Love vs. Vanity:

The central theme of the poem is **the exploration of true love versus vanity**. The lady expects Count de Lorge to risk his life for her out of love, but in reality, her request is fueled by vanity and the desire for public attention. Count de Lorge, while displaying his bravery by retrieving the glove, throws it in her face to show his disdain for her vanity, suggesting that genuine love should not be equated with dangerous, pointless displays of courage.

Courage and Bravery:

The theme of courage is explored through **Count de Lorge's act of jumping into the lion pit. He does this not out of love, as the lady expects, but out of his personal bravery and perhaps a desire to show the absurdity of her request.**

Topic: Word / Meaning

Word	Meaning
Hearty	an extremely cheerful and sporty person
Royal	having the status of a king or queen or a member of their family
Noble	belonging to a high social rank in a society
Pride	a feeling of deep pleasure or satisfaction derived from one's own achievements or possessions
Sighed	yearned, to have strong longing for; to have deep breath expressing despair
Gallant	brave; heroic
Crowing	magnificent; full of splendor

Topic: Word / Meaning

Word	Meaning
Valour	personal bravery; strength of mind or spirit
Beast	animals
Ramped	to move or act furiously; to stand or advance in a threatening manner with forelegs or with arms raised
Horrid	nasty; disgusting; shocking
Glared	to stare angrily or fiercely
Beams	rays or shafts of light
Wallowing	unrestrained; rolling with pleasure

Topic: Word / Meaning

Word	Meaning
Might	great or overwhelming power or strength
Stifled	muffled, choking
Mane	a growth of long hair on the neck of a horse; lion or another animal
Thunderous	extremely loud and deep noise
Smother	a dense cloud or covering
Whisking	moving suddenly and rapidly
Beauteous	beautiful; very attractive to look at high

Topic: Word / Meaning

Word	Meaning
Dame	a woman of high rank; status or dignity
Wondrous	marvelous; wonderful
Divine	supremely good
Leaped	jumped; sprung
Quoth	said
Vanity	inflated pride in oneself or one's appearance

Topic: MCQ

Where was King Francis seated?

A) Among the nobles

B) Among the lions (Mentioned in the poem)

C) **Above the royal beasts**

D) Next to the Count

The king above, the royal beasts below
(Stanza-1)

Topic: MCQ

Which literary device is used in "gave blows like beams"?

A) Alliteration

B) Onomatopoeia

C) Simile

D) Metaphor



Topic: ~~MCQ~~ Questions

Q. **Read the following extract from the poem The Haunted Houses and answer the following question:**

Ans.

De Lorge's love o'erheard the King, a beauteous lively dame With smiling lips and sharp bright eyes, which always seemed the same; She thought, the Count my lover is brave as brave can be;

HW

Q. **Which King is being referred to in the above lines? What did the lady do? What was the immediate cause that triggered her thought?**

Ans.

King Francis. She dropped the glove in the pit where the lions were fighting. King Francis remarked that it was safer for them to be seated far above the pit than where the lions were fighting below.

Topic: ~~MCQ~~ Questions

Q. How did the Count react to her action? What did he do later? Why?

Ans. The Count bowed and, in a moment, leapt among the lions. His leap was swift, quick and returned even quicker. He threw the glove at the lady's face with anger. This reaction was because he understood her motives, which were not love but arrogance and vanity.

Q. Describe the fight between the lions in the pit.

Ans. The ferocious lions ramped and roared with horrid laughing jaws. They bit, they glared and tore into one another. Their blows were powerful, like beams, and thewind seemed to move alongside their paws. They rolled over each other, and theirmanes were covered with sand and blood. It was a savage fight, and bloody foam whisked through the air.

Topic: ~~MCQ~~ Questions

Q. What message is the poet trying to convey through the poem?

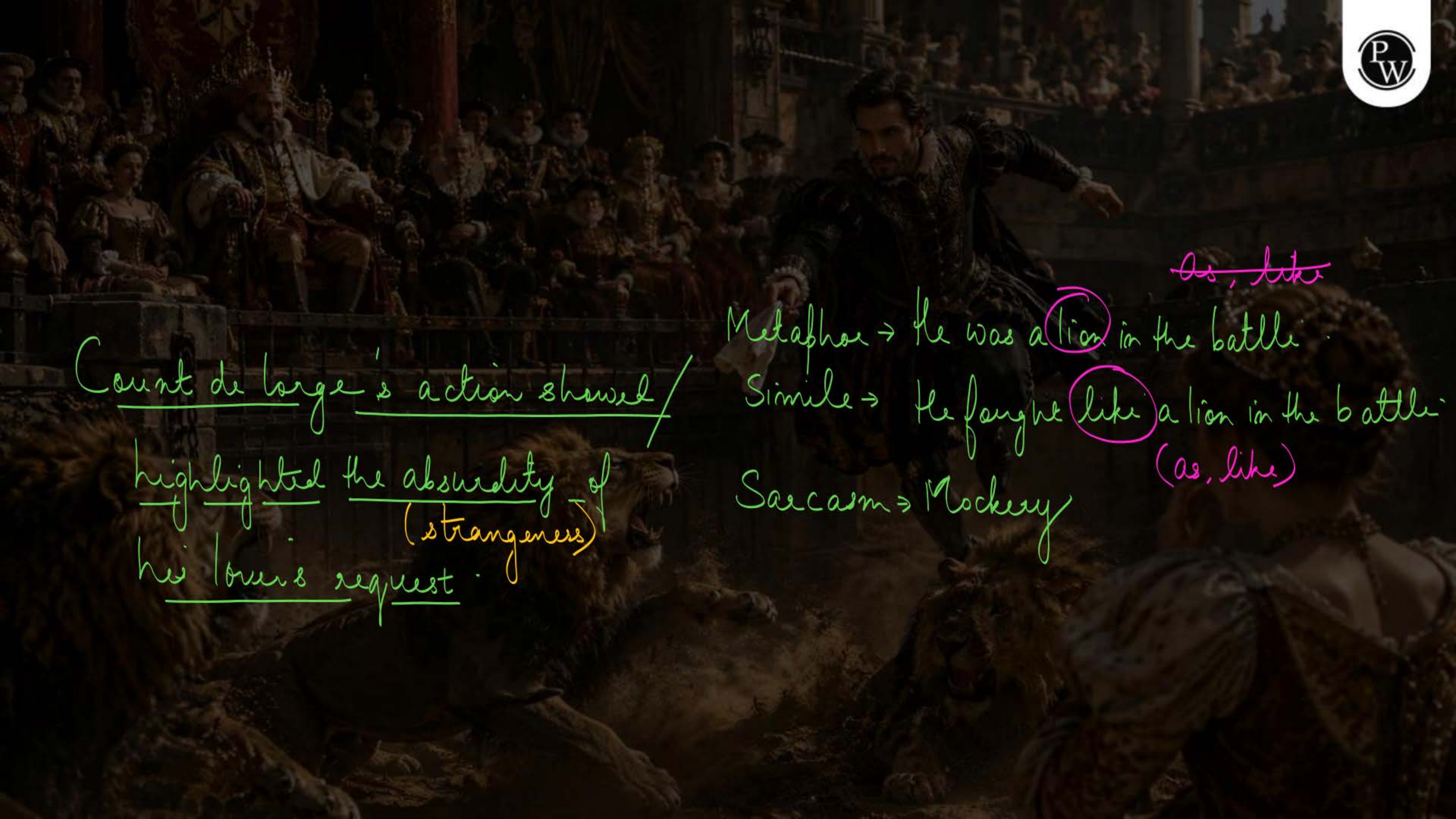
Ans. Love needs no authentication and validation/ a true lover can never set the life of a beloved in any peril / Vanity comes before a fall.

Q. What does the glove symbolise for:

(i) the Count

(ii) the Lady How would you describe the Count's mood at the end of the poem?

Ans. The Count: a challenge to prove his strength, valour, and chivalry. The Lady: a tool to seek the attention of all present/ her vanity. The mood of the Count was angry as he could see through the lady's cunning motive/ the lady's spell over him was broken/ proud of his valour. (any other plausible answer)



Count de Borge's action showed / highlighted the absurdity (strangeness) of his lover's request.

~~as, like~~

Metaphor → He was a lion in the battle.

Simile → He fought like a lion in the battle.
(as, like)

Sarcasm → Mockery


Thank You!